



Easy Air Fryer Zucchini Recipes With Cheese for Crispy, Flavorful Snacks

These air fryer zucchini recipes with cheese are my go-to for quick, crispy snacks that feel indulgent but are surprisingly easy to make. The secret is getting the zucchini perfectly tender inside with a golden, cheesy crust outside. Great for afternoon cravings or a simple side!



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15 min
PREP



15 min
COOK



30 min
TOTAL



4
SERVINGS



Easy
DIFFICULTY

Ingredients

- ☐ 3 medium zucchinis, sliced into 1/4-inch rounds
- ☐ 1 cup shredded mozzarella cheese
- ☐ 1/4 cup grated Parmesan cheese
- ☐ 1 teaspoon garlic powder
- ☐ 1/2 teaspoon salt
- ☐ 1/4 teaspoon black pepper

- 1 tablespoon olive oil
- Fresh parsley, chopped, for garnish

Instructions

- 1** Start by slicing the zucchinis into even 1/4-inch rounds. This thickness ensures they cook evenly in the air fryer without becoming too mushy or too dry. Toss the slices gently in olive oil to help the cheese stick and promote browning. Make sure each slice is coated but not dripping oily, as too much oil can make them soggy instead of crispy. ⌚ 5
- 2** In a large bowl, combine the garlic powder, salt, and pepper. Sprinkle this seasoning evenly over the zucchini slices and toss again to coat. Seasoning before air frying allows the flavors to penetrate the zucchini as it crisps up, enhancing the overall taste without overpowering the delicate vegetable flavor. ⌚ 3
- 3** Preheat your air fryer to 400°F (200°C) for about 3 minutes. Preheating is important because it helps the zucchini start crisping immediately when placed inside, avoiding sogginess that can happen if the air fryer is cold. ⌚ 3
- 4** Arrange the zucchini slices in a single layer in the air fryer basket. Overcrowding will cause steaming rather than crisping, so work in batches if necessary. The goal is for hot air to circulate freely around each piece for the best texture. ⌚ 2
- 5** Cook the zucchini in the air fryer for 10 minutes. At the 5-minute mark, carefully flip each slice to ensure even browning on both sides. This flipping is key to getting a consistent crispy texture and prevents burning on one side. ⌚ 10
- 6** Remove the basket and sprinkle the shredded mozzarella and Parmesan evenly over the zucchini slices. The cheese should cover the surface but not pile up too thickly, so it melts evenly and crisps slightly on top. ⌚ 2
- 7** Return the basket to the air fryer and cook for an additional 3–4 minutes at 400°F until the cheese is melted, bubbly, and slightly golden. Keep an eye to avoid burning the cheese; the bubbling stage is when it's perfect. ⌚ 4
- 8** Carefully remove the zucchini from the air fryer and transfer to a serving plate. Sprinkle freshly chopped parsley over the top for a pop of color and fresh flavor. This finishing touch brightens the dish and adds a subtle herbal note. ⌚ 2
- 9** Serve immediately while hot and crispy. These zucchini rounds are great on their own or paired with a creamy dip like ranch or garlic aioli. Enjoy the contrast of textures and the irresistible cheesy flavor! ⌚ 0

Chef Tips

☒ **Don't overcrowd the air fryer basket when cooking zucchini slices.**

Overcrowding traps moisture and prevents hot air from circulating evenly, leading to soggy, steamed zucchini instead of crispy rounds. Cooking in a single layer ensures each piece crisps properly, giving you that satisfying texture.

☒ **Flip zucchini slices halfway through cooking for even browning.**

Flipping exposes both sides to direct heat and air circulation, promoting uniform crispness. If you skip this step, one side may burn while the other remains undercooked, resulting in an uneven texture and flavor.

☒ **Use a mix of mozzarella and Parmesan cheese for flavor and texture balance.**

Mozzarella provides gooey meltiness while Parmesan adds sharpness and a crispy golden crust. This combination creates a more complex and satisfying cheesy topping than using a single cheese alone.

☒ **Preheat your air fryer before adding the zucchini slices.**

Preheating ensures the air fryer is at the right temperature to start crisping immediately. Adding food to a cold air fryer can cause soggy results because the zucchini releases moisture before the heat is sufficient to evaporate it quickly.

☒ **Slice zucchini evenly to ensure uniform cooking.**

Uneven slices cook at different rates, causing some pieces to be overdone while others remain undercooked. Consistent thickness helps all slices finish crisp and tender at the same time.

☒ **Pat zucchini slices dry before tossing with oil and seasoning if they seem wet.**

Excess moisture hinders browning and crisping. Drying helps the oil and seasoning adhere better and reduces steaming inside the air fryer, resulting in a more desirable crispy texture.

☒ **Serve zucchini immediately after cooking for the best texture.**

As zucchini cools, moisture can be reabsorbed, softening the crispy edges. Serving hot preserves the contrast between the tender inside and crispy outside, delivering the best eating experience.

Storage & Reheating

❏ Refrigerator

Store leftovers in an airtight container in the refrigerator for up to 3 days. The zucchini may soften slightly but reheating in the air fryer or oven restores some crispness. Avoid microwaving as it tends to make them soggy.

❏ Freezer

Freeze cooked zucchini pieces in a single layer on a baking sheet, then transfer to a freezer-safe container or bag for up to 1 month. Thaw in the refrigerator overnight before reheating. Reheat in the air fryer to regain crisp texture.

❏ Reheating

Reheat zucchini in the air fryer at 350°F for 3–5 minutes until warmed through and crispy again. Alternatively, use a 350°F oven for 7–10 minutes. Avoid microwaving to keep the texture crisp and cheese melty.

Nutrition (per serving)

180 kcal
CALORIES

12g
PROTEIN

8g
CARBS

12g
FAT

2g
FIBER

420mg
SODIUM

Nutritional values are estimates and may vary based on specific ingredients used.

Thank You

Thank you for choosing this recipe collection. We hope it brings warmth and flavor to your kitchen.



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